

MAKING PEACE

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THE WORLD IS HER STAGE: Indira Gandhi addressing the UN silver jubilee celebrations in 1970

<< REWIND



"In 1970, the United Nations will complete 25 years. Can we make it a year of peace?" asked Prime Minister Indira Gandhi in her address in New York. There was no peace in sight in the neighbourhood, though, with Pakistan President Ayub Khan rejecting India's offer of a 'no-war pact'. On the domestic front, too, the situation was grim. Over 1,300 died in the floods of north Bengal and there was scarcity in Rajasthan, while violence followed the arrest of Naxalite leader Kanu Sanyal as Communists in Kerala turned violent, attacking police stations and staging protests.

TAMIL PRIDE C.N. Annadurai

Two decades of unrivalled Congress rule in Tamil Nadu came to an end in the 1967 elections, which also saw the rise of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam under playwright-politician Conjeevaram Natarajan Annadurai. The Congress suffered a humiliating defeat at the hands of the regional party, which won 138 of the 234 seats in the state Assembly. The Congress is still to regain power in the state. Under Anna, as he was called by his followers, the Dravidian nationalists in the party took up cudgels against the imposition of Hindi as the national language. A witty orator and a prolific writer, his tenure as chief minister was cut short when he died in 1969. Anna was succeeded by his protegee and writer Muthuvel Karunanidhi.



FIRST CUT

• Asia's first ever heart transplant operation was performed by Dr Prafulla Kumar Sen and other surgeons at KEM Hospital, Bombay. He was only the

third surgeon in the world to achieve this feat.

• India's first meteorological rocket, Menaka, was successfully launched at the Thumba Equatorial Rocket Launching Station in Kerala.

<< DID YOU KNOW

The *mehendi* ceremony in Rajiv and Sonia Gandhi's wedding was conducted at the Bachchans' Willingdon Crescent home. The couple got married on February 28.